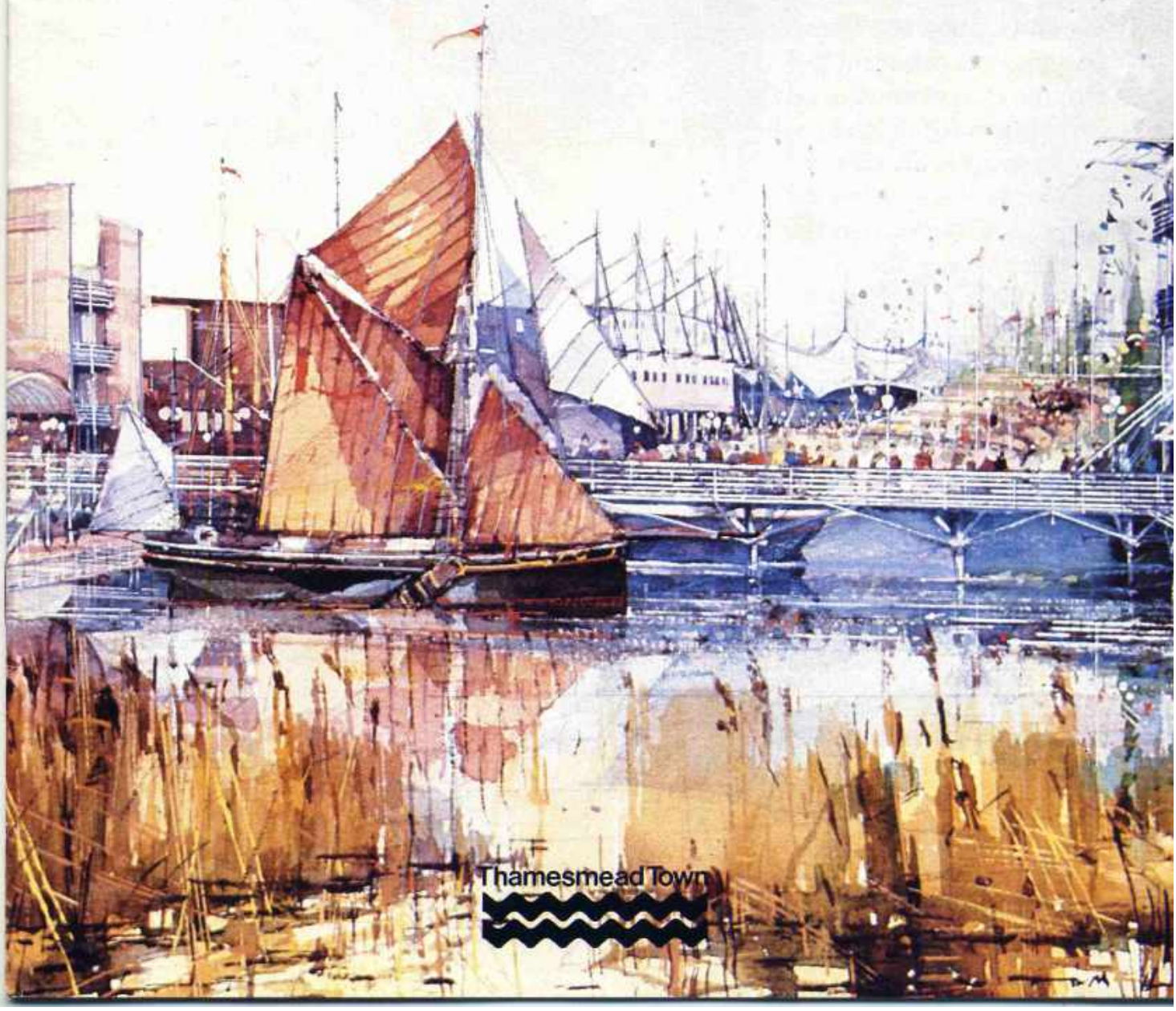
DEVELOPING THAMESMEAD

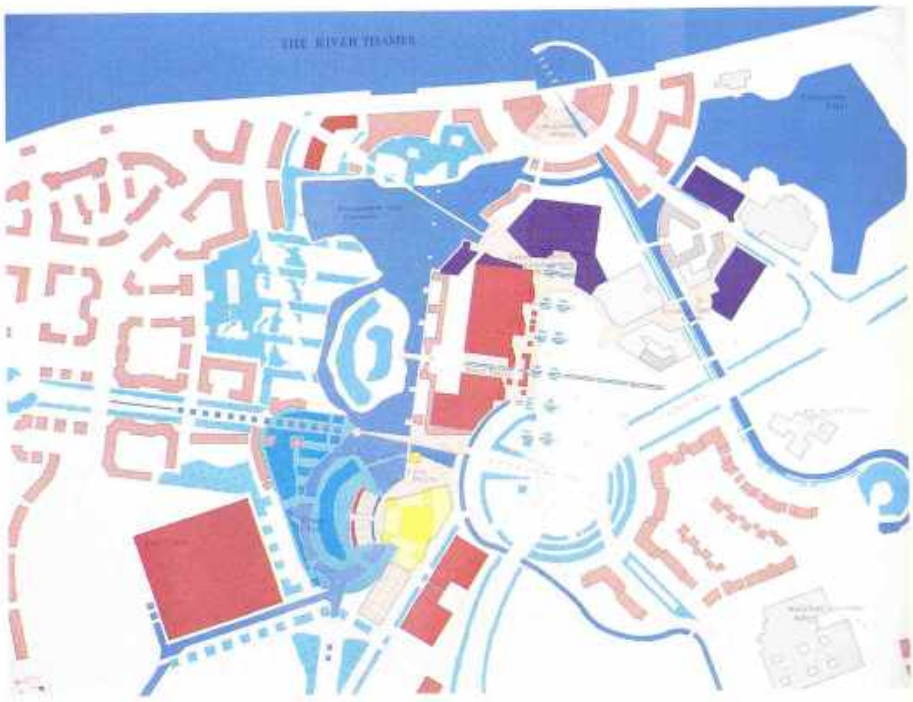
Town Centre Expansion



Thamesmead Town

The Company

The unique situation at Thamesmead occurred after a local referendum in October 1985. A private company limited by guarantee was set up, controlled entirely by Thamesmead residents. The Thamesmead Town Company purchased the GLC's interest in Thamesmead in July 1987, and became responsible for the management and development of its own community. The Board of twelve consists of nine locally elected Directors, who then appoint three Executive Directors (the Chairman, Chief Executive and Finance Director).





The Project



The project to expand Thamesmead Town Centre is the most important scheme ever undertaken in the Town. It will bring a superstore, other retail shops, leisure, and entertainment facilities to the heart of Thamesmead. With this new focus, the Town will become a more exciting place to live, enjoying all the convenience of a major shopping centre and the fun of much more entertainment.

The Town Centre is expanding south and west, adjacent to Central Way. It will be built next to the lake, with waterside cafe-bars and bistros. The existing Twin Tumps - the old Arsenal's moated ammunition stores - will be conserved; the ecological significance of the Northern Tump will be enhanced and retained as a natural study area, with the Southern Tump being used for more active leisure and recreation.



The land between the Lake and the River Thames, opposite the Town Centre - Development Area 6 - will be developed as a residential area with extensive parklands around Tripcock Point.

The Town Centre of the future will be an exciting place to visit, with its lakeside setting and new leisure opportunities. It will also be a bustling shopping centre where residents will find a wider range and larger number of retail outlets. This proposal includes a new superstore - Sainsbury's Savacentre - which will offer a wide variety of goods and services, with easy parking.

Savacentre

Savacentre is Britain's only company dedicated to developing hypermarkets in the UK. It was founded in 1975 and was owned in equal parts by BhS and Sainsbury's. The full range of Sainsbury's groceries and fresh foods is in each store with a wide selection of clothing for all , housewares, lighting, toys, electrical goods and Homebase gardening and DIY products.

There are currently nine Savacentre hypermarkets of which London Colney is the largest. Each new hypermarket is approximately three times the size of a new Sainsbury's supermarket and employs around 1,000 staff, offering a variety of employment opportunities for full and part time work.

There are special counters where staff are able to serve fresh foods to customers: fresh fish, exotic and familiar delicatessen products, and bread and cakes from the in-store bakery.

Groceries found at any large, modern Sainsbury's are found also in Savacentre, including Sainsbury's own label and branded goods. Many items are at specially low prices, with 'Star Buy' and 'Multisava' offers.

Top quality clothing for men and women is available at value-for-money prices. Teens and children are catered for as well, from clothes to books, stationery and toys. At London Colney, a Mothercare concession looks after the youngest customers and their mums.

Savacentres have a variety of housewares and cookwares from Sainsbury's, BhS and other leading manufacturers. There is a range of gardening and DIY equipment and accessories from Sainsbury's Homebase, and keenly priced electrical goods.

























Specialist stores-within-the-store provide other facilities for customers. These can include a post office and dispensing chemist. .

Shopping at Savacentre is made convenient for customers with late night opening six days a week. Payment may be made by Access or Visa at the credit desk for home and leisure departments.

Most Savacentre stores have restaurant giving full meals, light snacks or a selection from a wide range of pastries.

Customer toilets are also provided, with special facilities for disabled visitors. A baby changing room and special trolleys for babies are also available. Public telephones are conveniently located.

Specially allocated car parking spaces are reserved close to the store entrance for disabled customers. Revolving doors can amply accommodate a wheel chair and adapted trolleys can be fitted to help with shopping. Customer service assistants are there to help customers with their shopping.

A petrol filling station serves leaded and unleaded petrol and deisel fuel for cars and vans at competitive prices. Payment can be made by Access, Visa, Switch Card, cheque or cash.

Free car parking is available for customers at all new Savacentre developments. Recycling facilities for glass, cans and newspapers may also be found, conveniently located in or near the car park.

The first Savacentre opened in 1977, there are now nine successfully trading throughout Britain:

- Edinburgh
- Washington
- Sheffield
- Oldbury
- Calcot, Reading
- London Colney, St Albans
- Basildon
- Merton
- Gillingham

Development Area 6

A complete new neighbourhood for about 3,000 residents is planned for Development Area 6. This will extend from the Twin Tumps, adjacent to the new Town Centre, to the proposed East London River Crossing at the western end of the site, and bounded to the north by the River Thames.

Large parts of this area have already been reclaimed in anticipation of development. Existing woodlands to the south of Tripcock Point will be retained and improved to form the basis of a major new park. Other small groups of existing trees will be retained wherever possible to enhance the proposed development.

The proposals, however, will need to remain flexible to be able to respond to changing requirements over the 10-15 year time span envisaged to implement the plan.

The fine views of the river, and the fact that it is next to extensive parklands, make the northern parts of Area 6 an ideal place for a residential community.

The residents of Area 6 will enjoy these natural advantages, and will also be within easy walking distance of the newly expanded Town Centre.

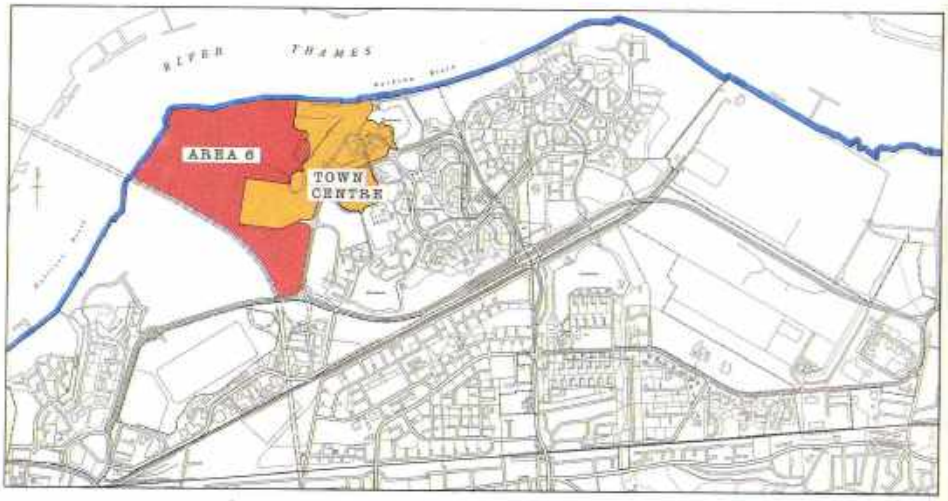
They will be able to stroll along the Thameside Walk and visit the ecological park on the northern Twin Tump.

There is a store building, over 100 years old, in Area 6 near the lake which will be preserved.

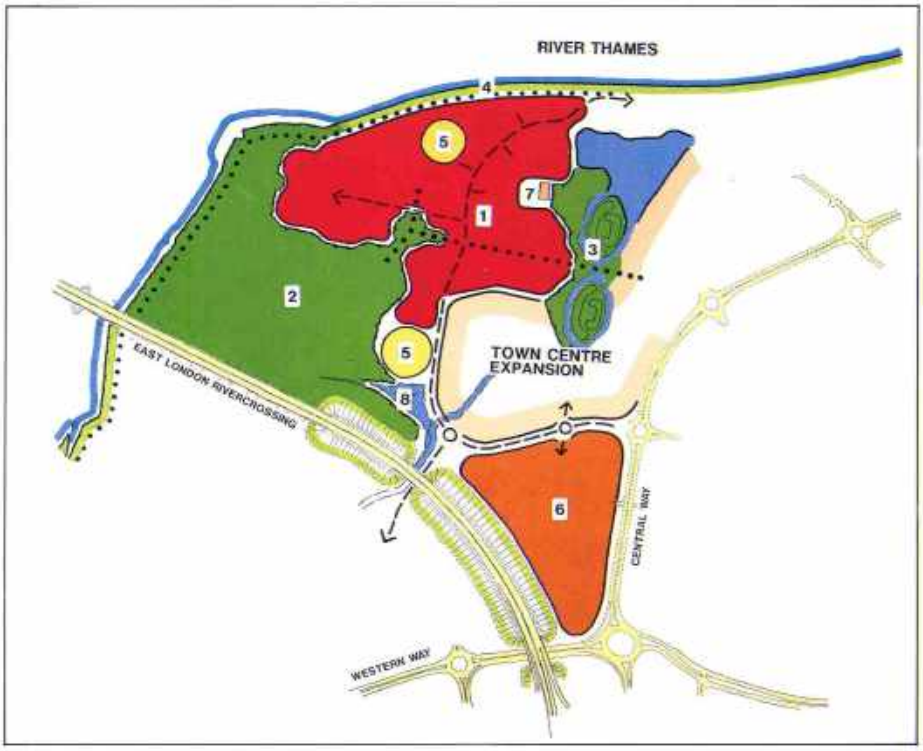
A 'Wetlands Nature Reserve' has been proposed for the south of the area, which will be an unusual ecological park, but these details are yet to be finalised.

The Southern Triangle site has excellent road access, which makes it attractive for either further residential or other appropriate development.





Development Area 6



THE RESIDENTIAL AREA

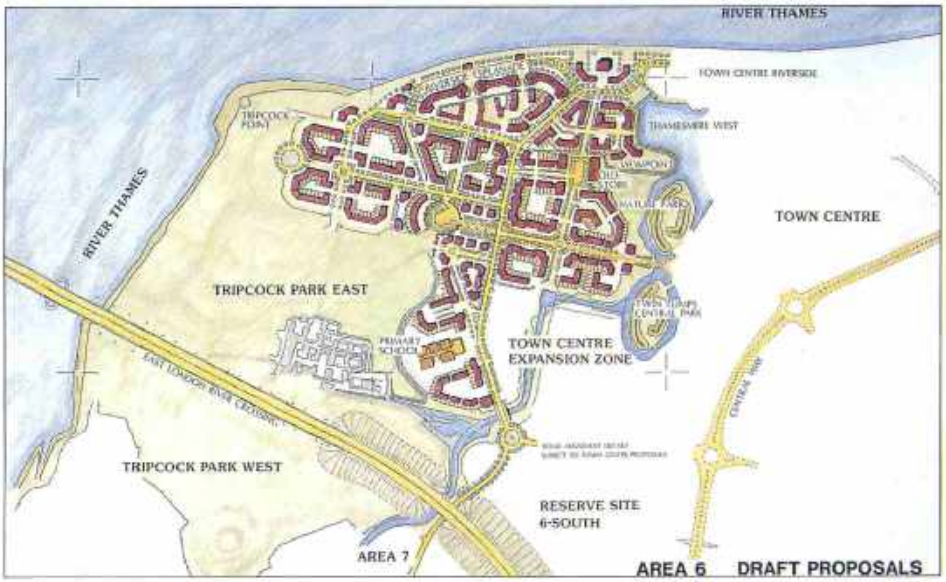
The proposals for the residential parts of Area 6 were inspired by the traditional form of street block layout.

There will be two-to-four storey houses and flats, fronting onto a tree-lined local road network. Traffic speeds within the residential areas will be kept low by some specially designed features. Particular care will be taken to retain existing landscape features.

A fine example is a dominant group of trees, which form the centrepiece of this area, and will become the focal point of the major pedestrian route from the Town Centre,.

There are plans for a distributor road which will carry bus services through the area to other parts of Thamesmead.

A site has been identified, within the area, for a primary school to serve the needs of local residents.



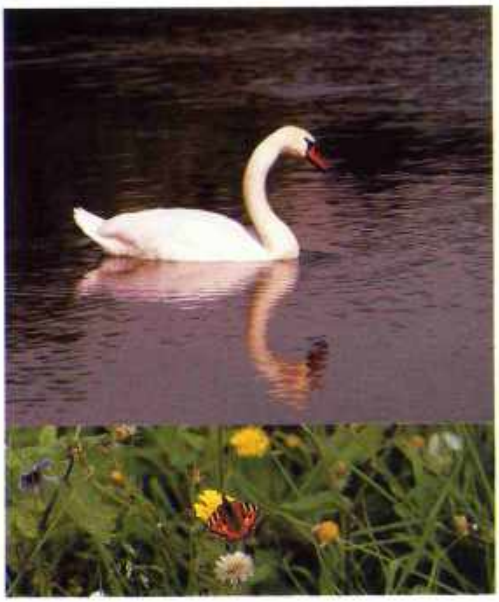
Ecology

Some areas of the site are wild, overgrown and largely undisturbed since it was abandoned by the Royal Arsenal 30 years ago.



Wildlife experts have been called in to survey the plants and animals which have made a home in this part of Thamesmead. They have found a great variety of many different types of habitat in the old Arsenal's munitions stores, known as the 'Twin Tumps'.







Adaptations to the Twin Tumps enclosures will enable them to be retained as reminders of Thamesmead's past and as a lush, green setting for the new Town Centre. As a pioneer in urban nature conservation, Thamesmead will ensure that this setting will provide one of the permanent homes for its rich wildlife heritage.